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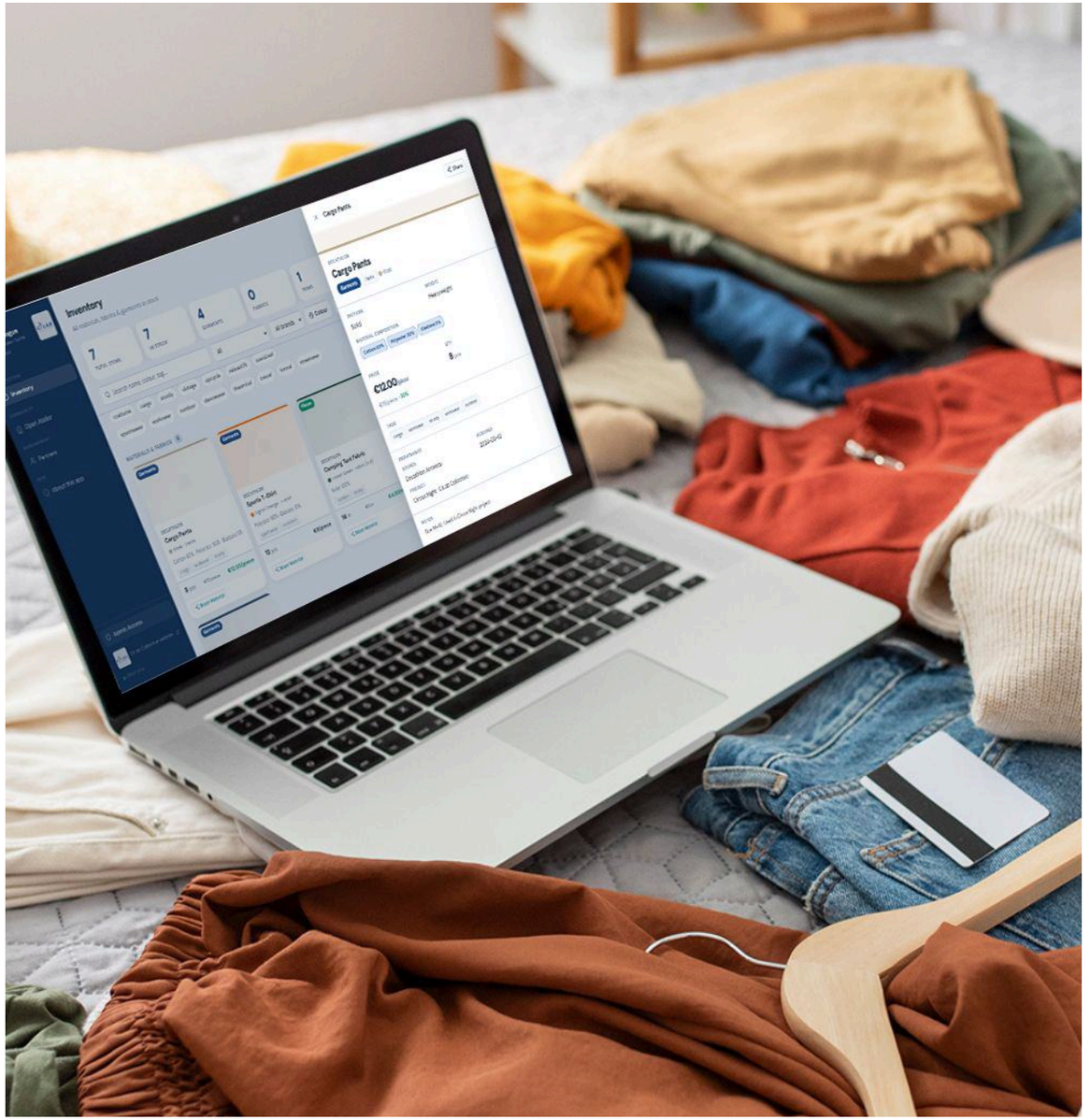
2026

Mechelen

Making circular textile services easier to access

My role: *Service research · Stakeholder interviews · Service blueprint · Spatial organisation · Digital inventory concept · UX/UI concept*

Methods & tools: *stakeholder interviews · service blueprint · journey mapping · workflow mapping · spatial audit · QR-code system concept · Figma/Canva · website prototyping*



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WHO IS CILAB

Strong social mission



CILAB AND ITS VALUES

CiLAB is a circular textile atelier in Mechelen where citizens can **repair, upcycle, exchange or donate garments and materials.** The goal of the founder is to facilitate the transition to **circular textiles and be a community hub** , not just a service provider: creating social impact alongside economic activity and supporting social inclusion through meaningful work

No structure, no record

Limited visibility

Time consuming



THE CHALLENGE

CiLAB's services and material stock were valuable but **difficult to access**. Workers often relied on **personal memory** to locate fabrics, tools and ongoing projects, while visitors had limited visibility of available services and materials before arriving.
That's why Jan, my mentor, asked me to design a service system and a material library to retain this information and make it clear for the public and workers.



OUTCOME

I explored how this growing service could become easier to navigate for both visitors and staff.
The final design is a **connected service system combining an Open Atelier model, a clearer material-storage logic, QR-supported inventory management and a digital platform.**

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RESEARCH AND FIRST STEPS

> The key question became: How might CiLAB make circular textiles visible, findable and usable without creating extra work for its team?

1:1 Talks with people involved:

Internal team



Jan (logistics, policies), Sibille (art director)

Abaseen , isa and Mumtaz(sewing experts)

Users
Clients
Partners



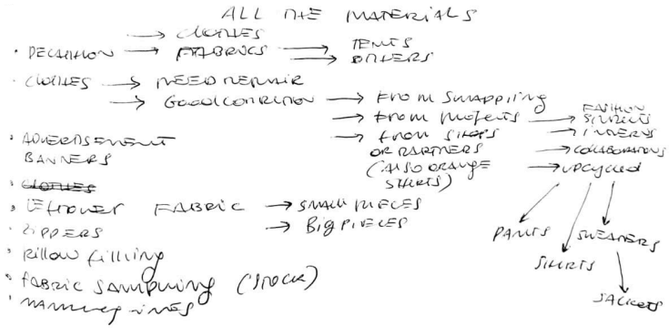
Worker question

1. Do we have it?
2. Where is it?

External question

1. Can you do *this*?
2. Where can i see?

From this



To this

Total items	In stock	Garnments
Fabrics	Projects	Trims
WIP	Partners	Zones

work in progress

archive





MY APPROACH

- Observed daily workflows and material-handling practices.
- Interviewed CiLAB team members and people familiar with the organisation.
- Identified pain points in material retrieval, client communication, storage and service visibility(SWOT ANALYSIS)
- Mapped relationships between staff, visitors, partners, space and digital tools.

FROM MICRO TO MACRO (CATEGORIES)

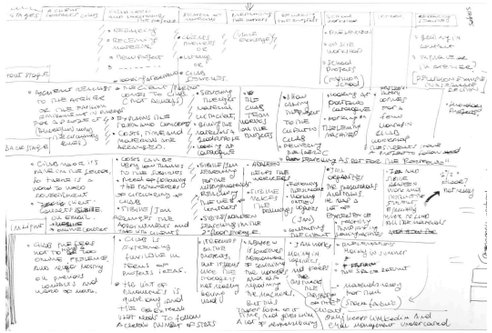
From fragmented storage to one connected service.
I translated the research into a service concept that links the physical atelier with a digital inventory. Numbered **storage zones**, clear visual signage and QR codes give each material a traceable location, while an online catalogue helps visitors understand what is available before they visit.

THE ZONES

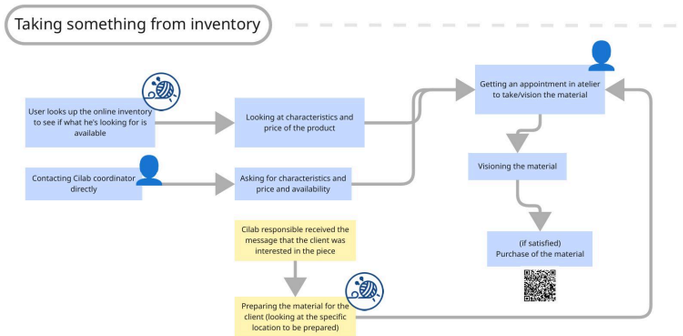
- **Digital inventory** for fabrics, garments, tools and projects.
- **QR-coded storage zones and material IDs.**
- **Clearer zones** for repairs, ongoing projects, tools, donations and swapping.
- Online service information for machine rental, mentoring, repairs and material access.
- An Open Atelier model that supports local participation and circular practices.

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FUNCTIONALITY



From this



To this (Service blue print of inventory)

SERVICE BLUE PRINT

I developed a service blueprint to align the client journey with staff responsibilities, the physical workshop and the supporting digital system. The blueprint clarified how **requests, booking, material search, repair, pickup and inventory** updates could work as one coherent process.



Adding a new material needs to be fast

Private section for the workers

Clear zoning

USER TESTING

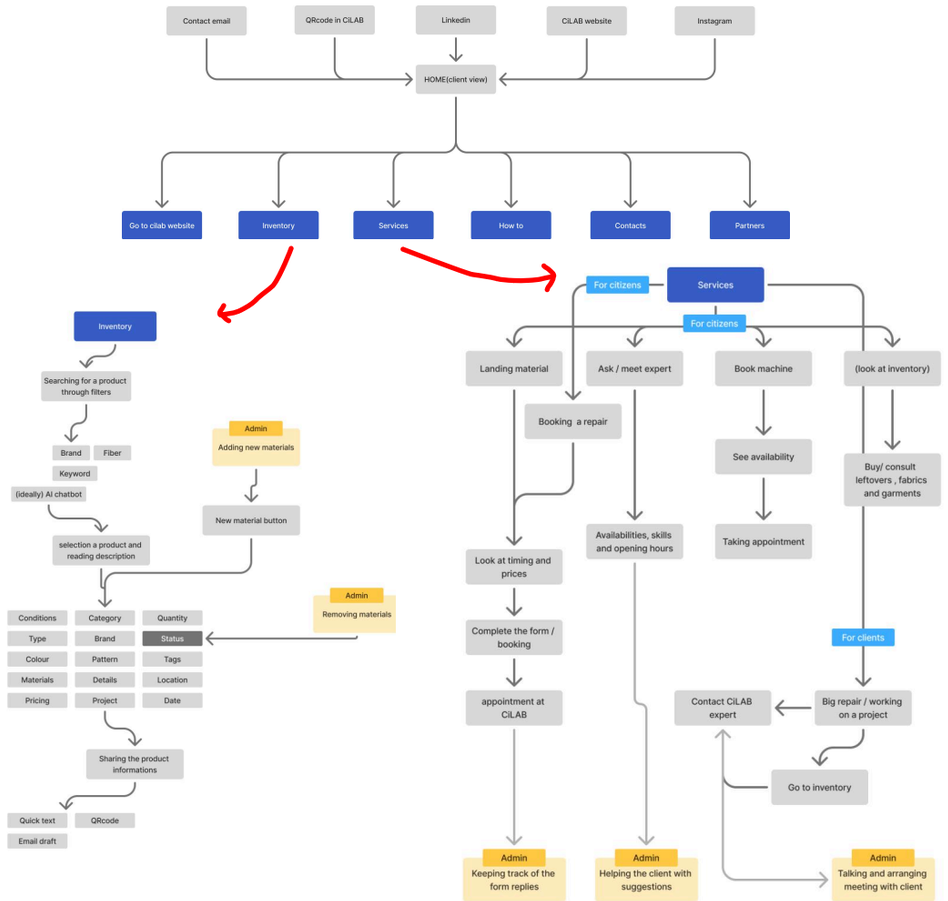
To ensure that the prototypes (three different ones present in my website) where **adaptable to the pre-existent service** and system, i did some experiments and trials with the CiLAB team

Different tasks where given to the workers:

- Looking up materials for a test project
- Logging in and adding a garnment
- Uploading pictures
- Adding a new zone in the physical space

Cilab website shortcut





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WHY A MATERIAL LIBRARY?

Services for public

Renting a machine

Taking from inventory

Requesting a repair

Mentoring

Services for clients and partners

Envisioning materials

Looking at projects

Sending material sheet for requests

Direct contacts and availabilities

Services for workers(cilab)

Keeping track of material

Easier flow

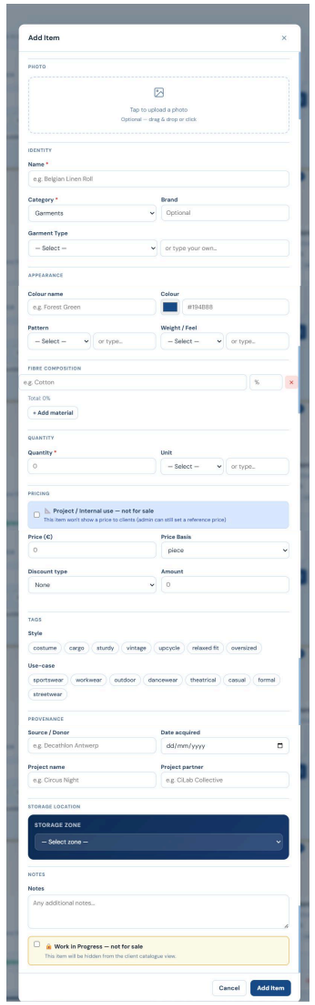
Online database

Easier to help citizens

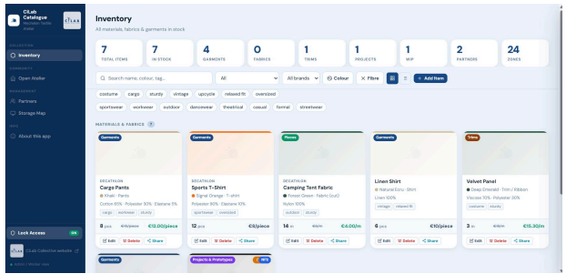
Faster communication with clients

THE IMPACT

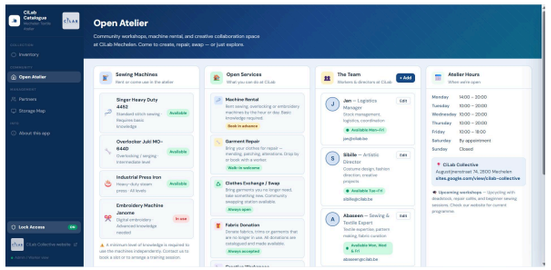
The proposed concept reduces dependence on individual memory, supports faster material retrieval and gives visitors clearer access to CiLAB's services. It also strengthens CiLAB's role as a community hub for repair, reuse and textile circularity.



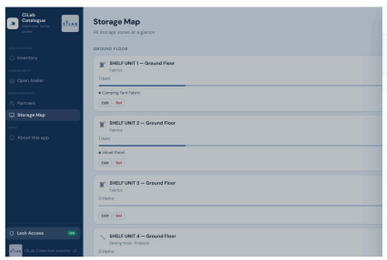
Admin access
--> product information



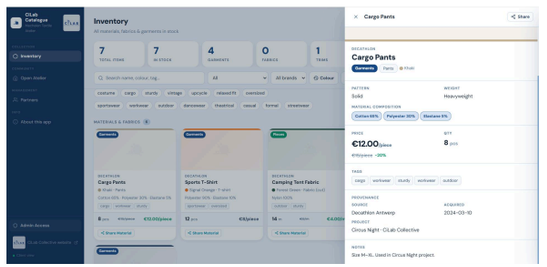
Main page --> admin access



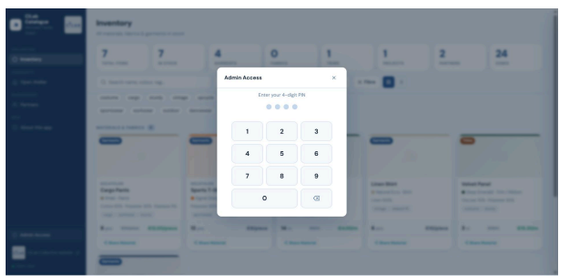
Open atelier section



Admin access --> storage locations and QR

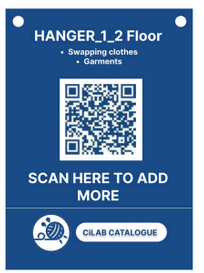


Admin access--> garnments information



Code for admin access





QRcode system

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